

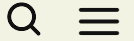
Support Gothamist's journalism

BECOME A SPONSOR

Gothamist

Gothamist

Donate



NEWS

Brooklyn Couple Rescues Chicken From Ritual Slaughter & Makes It Their House Pet



By Rebecca Fishbein

Published Sep 9, 2015

Modified Sep 9, 2015

5 comments

Share



We rely on your support to make local news available to all

Make your contribution now and help Gothamist thrive in 2026. [Donate today.](#)

With the Jewish holiday of Yom Kippur only a few weeks away, there's been some renewed discussion about Kaporos, a controversial Ultra-Orthodox ritual in which participants wave a live chicken three times over their heads before slaughtering it. Animal rights activists have long since argued that the ritual is a cruel practice, staging protests, filing lawsuits, and even rescuing chickens. One Brooklyn couple has even been raising a spared Kaporos chicken in their

Read this story completely free

To continue reading, sign up for our daily newsletter and get unlimited access to Gothamist.com. [Why am I seeing this?](#)

Email address

your@email.com

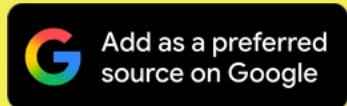
Sign Up

☒ By submitting your information, you're agreeing to receive communications from New York Public Radio in accordance with our [Terms](#).

[No thanks](#)

Make it easier to follow Gothamist's reporting

You can personalize your search results to see more stories from the sources you trust.



[Click to add Gothamist as a preferred source.](#)

Tagged

BROOKLYN

KAPOROS

PENELOPE

PENELOPE THE CHICKEN

ORIGINAL

G

Rebecca Fishbein

[Read more](#)

Conversation 5 Comments

Commenting on this article has ended

 [Log in](#) | [Sign up](#)

Sort by **Best** ▾

G

GoldHammer

10 September, 2015

I just googled "chicken diaper." New low in internet rabbit holes.

  • [Share](#)

P

PurpleMustache

10 September, 2015

Love how the title of this refers to the sentient being as an "it" and the more complicated issue of as a "pet" as opposed to refugee...

  • [Share](#)

R

RedCarrot

13 September, 2015

Religious freedom line should be drawn at cruelty and killing. SHAME on the people killing chickens in the name of religion and in an attempt to absolve their sins. Their sins are magnitudes worse as a result. DISGRACEFUL. If they truly wanted to absolve sins, they would be doing the opposite - res...

See more

  • [Share](#)

R

RedCarrot

13 September, 2015

Vanessa and Steve, thank you for your wonderful hearts....

👍 🗨 • Share

G

GreenGoggles

25 September, 2015

I raised a banty rooster whom I named Butchy. One he got his feathers in I let him live outside and he was very protective of me. Every time he saw me coming out the backdoor he would run to greet me. Once a big mean tom turkey tried to get me and my little Butchy jumped on the turkeys back and sta...

See more

👍 🗨 • Share

Powered by  OpenWeb

[Terms](#) | [Privacy](#) | [Feedback](#)

MORE NEWS



A sixth person dies after falling ill in NYPD custody this year

The 54-year-old was hospitalized twice after his arrest Friday, police said.



By Ryan Kost

Published Oct 4, 2026

7 comments

NEWS NJ reports first West Nile Virus death of the year

While the national West Nile Virus trend has slowed down, activity in the Garden State has picked up.

By Michael Sol Warren

1 comment



NY's prison system is in crisis. It's driving staff away from the job.

By Emily Russell

43 comments

NYPD searching for suspect after fatal stabbing in Queens

By Ben Feuerherd

18 comments

NYPD: 2 suspects in officer stabbing

By Jill Webb

9 comments

Never miss a story

Catch up on the most important headlines with a roundup of essential NYC stories, delivered to your inbox daily.

Email address

your@email.com

Sign up



By submitting your information, you're agreeing to receive communications from New York Public Radio in accordance with our [Terms](#).

Gothamist

Gothamist is a website about New York City news, arts, events and food,
brought to you by New York Public Radio.

ADVERTISING

CONTACT US

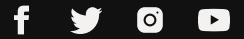
OUR TEAM

RSS FEED

DIVERSITY (DEI)

CAREERS

[Terms Of Use](#)



[Privacy Policy](#)

[Accessibility](#)

©2026 New York Public Radio. All rights reserved.